

BERG BALANCE SCALE (BBS)

Clinical Assessment of Balance Function and Fall Risk

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

1. SITTING & TRANSFERS (PART 1)**1. Sitting to Standing**

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Minimal assist (1) (1)
- ☐ Uses hands (2) (2)
- ☐ Independent (4) (4)

2. Standing Unsupported

- ☐ Unable (0) (0)
- ☐ Stands 30s (2) (2)
- ☐ Stands 2 min supervision (3) (3)
- ☐ Stands 2 min safely (4) (4)

3. Sitting Unsupported

- ☐ Unable (0) (0)
- ☐ Sits 30s (2) (2)
- ☐ Sits 2 min supervision (3) (3)
- ☐ Sits 2 min safely (4) (4)

4. Standing to Sitting

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Awkward landing (1) (1)
- ☐ Uses back of legs (2) (2)
- ☐ Sits safely (4) (4)

5. Transfers

- ☐ Needs 2 people (0) (0)
- ☐ Needs 1 person (1) (1)
- ☐ Needs verbal cue (2) (2)
- ☐ Independent safely (4) (4)

6. Standing Eyes Closed

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Unable 3s (1) (1)
- ☐ Stands 3s (2) (2)
- ☐ Stands 10s safely (4) (4)

7. Standing Feet Together

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Unable 15s (1) (1)
- ☐ Supervision 1 min (3) (3)
- ☐ Stands 1 min safely (4) (4)

2. DYNAMIC BALANCE (PART 2)**8. Reaching Forward**

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Reaches <5cm (1) (1)
- ☐ Reaches >12cm (3) (3)
- ☐ Reaches >25cm safely (4) (4)

9. Pick Up Object

- ☐ Unable (0) (0)
- ☐ Supervision (1) (1)
- ☐ Awkwardly (3) (3)
- ☐ Picks up safely (4) (4)

10. Turning Behind

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Supervision (1) (1)
- ☐ One side only (2) (2)
- ☐ Looks both sides safely (4) (4)

11. Turn 360 Degrees

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Takes >4s (2) (2)
- ☐ Turns safely ≤4s both ways (4) (4)

12. Dynamic Step Stool

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ <2 steps (1) (1)
- ☐ 4 steps (2) (2)
- ☐ 8 steps ≤20s safely (4) (4)

13. Tandem Stance

- ☐ Needs assist (0) (0)
- ☐ Small step 30s (1) (1)
- ☐ Independent tandem 30s safely (4) (4)

14. Standing One Leg

- ☐ Unable (0) (0)
- ☐ Holds <3s (1) (1)
- ☐ Holds 5-10s (3) (3)
- ☐ Holds >10s safely (4) (4)

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 56 points)

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS**High Fall Risk (0-20 pts)**

Wheelchair user / 100% fall risk. Full assistance, fall protocol.

Moderate Fall Risk (21-40 pts)

Assisted ambulation (walker/cane), physical therapy gait training.

Low Fall Risk (41-56 pts)

Independent ambulation; maintain activity, environmental precautions.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment